AHEAD WITH KK

Layout guide: make every customer walk past your best sellers

for shops, showrooms, clinics with a retail corner, cafes

What I saw. In a Bangalore mall, the next escalator down was across the floor. I walked past a toy train, restaurants and every shop on the way. My take: malls put the big crowd pullers far apart, so you cross everything in between.

1. Find your "escalator"

- What do most people come in for? Milk in a grocery, the trial room in a clothing store, the billing counter, the service desk.

2. Move it to the back

- Not hidden, just far from the door. Put a clear sign at the entrance so nobody feels lost.

3. Line the path with your best sellers

- High margin items and new arrivals along the walk. Eye level, faced forward, full.

4. Don't block the first few steps

- People need a moment to slow down after the door. Retail researcher Paco Underhill filmed shoppers and called it the decompression zone. Keep that first space open and calm.

5. Make the way out pass one more thing

- A small impulse item near billing or the exit.

6. Test it

- Watch 20 customers for one afternoon: where do they stop? Move one product into a stop spot and count sales for 2 weeks.

Practical steps, not guaranteed results. Don't make customers feel trapped; a longer path only works if it's pleasant.